tone," Bajpai felt as a consequence, "for the time being, at any rate, we are isolated, and that over Kashmir and other issues, Pakistan and our enemies will exploit our isolation to the full."[223]

Beyond disillusionment, a more visible impact of the China-related friction was the reaction to India's first major request for bilateral assistance from the US in December 1950. Delhi had asked for food aid. There was debate within the Truman administration—not so much on the desirability of aiding India economically, but on the feasibility given the cost and congressional attitude. While there were a number of US-India disagreements, Acheson told the Indian ambassador frankly that Congress would basically watch India's approach on two matters: (1) Kashmir and (2) Korea, especially India's response to greater Chinese involvement.[224]

India's attitude toward the Korean War, where the US was directly involved, evoked a greater reaction in Congress than the subject of Kashmir. When Assistant Secretary of State George McGhee reached out to the Senate Foreign Relations Committee chair Tom Connally (D-TX) to facilitate passage of an aid bill in January 1951, the senator bluntly noted that sentiments toward India, greatly affected by its China policy, would make the task difficult.[225] He refused to move quickly on Indian food assistance, referring the question to a subcommittee.[226] There, McGhee tried to argue that the grant would have a "strong conditioning effect" on Nehru's policies and Indians' sentiments. If, however, the US did nothing despite its resources and large numbers of people died, the Indian people "will know at that time that Mr. Nehru and we were on the outs over the question of Communist China, and an inference will be very strong to them that we denied this request because we did not like the political attitude Mr. Nehru expressed."

But Connally retorted, "Nehru is out giving us hell at the time, working against us and voting against us" and was unlikely to change his approach. Senator Guy Gillette (D-IA) said he did not want to do anything to stabilize Nehru's position. And Senator J. William Fulbright (D-AK) said that India should pay for the food. He added that he did not like what appeared to be blackmail, with India arguing, "Give it to us or we will go Communist." McGhee argued that the US had already lost China and could not afford to lose India too, but when Fulbright asked if India, especially given its